Dawūd Vermeulen

Full-Stack Developer | TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, tRPC
Cape Town, South Africa | +27 60 616 9909 | vermeulend002@gmail.com | Remote / Hybrid / On-site
Portfolio: dawudvermeulen.vercel.app | dawuds.place | github.com/Dave-Vermeulen

SUMMARY

Developer based in Cape Town with a background in QA, IT support, and operations. Joined Tech Genius as a tester, built their automated testing infrastructure from the ground up, and was promoted to developer seven months later. I now work full-stack on a production TypeScript Next.js application, covering backend tRPC routes and CouchDB data layers through to React frontend pages. I pick things up quickly, work well under pressure, and I am straightforward about where my gaps are. Outside of my main role I co-founded GO2TECH Africa and run a free coding programme for young people in Wynberg. I am looking for a mid-level developer role at an established company where the work is challenging and the team has high standards. Open to remote roles including international.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Junior Software Developer | Tech Genius, Brackenfell, South Africa

January 2026 to present

Promoted from Software Tester after seven months, having contributed to the production codebase throughout my QA role.

- Build and ship complete feature modules on a production Next.js application: tRPC routers, CouchDB and PouchDB queries, Zod input schemas, and full React frontends using MUI components, React Hook Form, and NextAuth role-based access control.
- Work across a Turborepo monorepo with shared TypeScript config and component libraries. Contribute to Docker builds and CI/CD pipeline processes alongside the senior development team.
- Responsible for full CRUD page modules from backend to frontend, following architecture patterns established by the senior developer. Frontend work includes form builds, bug fixes, responsive MUI layouts, and resolving TypeScript lint errors across the codebase.
- Continue to maintain the Playwright E2E test suite I originally built, keeping coverage above 60 automated test cases as new features are released.

Software Tester | Tech Genius, Brackenfell, South Africa

June 2025 to January 2026

- Joined as the first and only tester on a production agile team. Built the full QA function from nothing: wrote the testing strategy, set up Playwright for E2E automation, configured TestRail for test case management, and established the Jira defect workflow.
- Learned TypeScript and Playwright in the first month and delivered over 60 automated end-to-end tests covering the core user flows of the application.
- Wrote a database cleanup script that automated a repetitive manual task for the development team, saving roughly 2 to 3 hours per week during active development cycles.
- Produced user stories and technical documentation to keep client requirements clearly mapped to what was being built.

Co-Founder and CTO | GO2TECH Africa, Cape Town, South Africa

2025 to present

- Co-founding a WhatsApp-first business automation platform for African SMEs. Leading all technical decisions including product architecture, technology stack, and MVP development.

Technical Consultant | g0g0's X Roads, South Africa

September 2024 to May 2025

- Managed QA and customer experience for QuranBook.com from early development through to launch in early 2025. Covered exploratory testing, manual end-to-end testing, UI/UX feedback, user story writing, and go-live documentation.
- Runner-up at the 2024 Astron Energy Startup Pitch Competition with a disruptive domestic distribution model. Also delivered a full website build, domain setup, and digital transformation roadmap for Sureco Trading.

IT Support Specialist | Pixel Faerie, Cape Town, South Africa

April 2024 to September 2024

- Wrote a PowerShell script that automated desktop cleanup on production machines, reducing the process from around 45 minutes to under 5. Used SQL queries to retrieve timesheet and slideshow data for the business team. Supported a cloud migration and contributed to fault-tolerant infrastructure design.

Prompt Engineer and Junior Full-Stack Developer | Medici Energy, Cape Town, South Africa

April 2023 to August 2023

- Automated bookkeeping workflows across 33 international entities using Python, NumPy, and Excel VBA, cutting manual data entry time by around 70%. Built and deployed PHP modules for Magento 2 and contributed to the DevOps deployment pipeline.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, PHP
Frontend: React, Next.js, MUI, React Hook Form, Zustand, HTML, CSS
Backend: Node.js, tRPC, Next.js API routes, Zod, NextAuth.js, REST APIs
Databases: CouchDB, PouchDB, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Testing: Playwright, Jest, TDD, Manual Testing, Exploratory Testing, TestRail, Postman
DevOps and Tools: Docker, Turborepo, CI/CD, AWS, GCP, GitHub, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, VS Code
Process: Scrum, Agile, Kanban, Sprint Planning, Technical Documentation
Languages: English, Afrikaans, Arabic

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

ITP in Web Development | CodeYourFuture, London, United Kingdom | *April 2024 to January 2025*
JavaScript, Python, HTML, CSS, Git, Agile, Kanban

Java SE 8 OCA | FreeThink Software Development / Manpower Group ZA | *June 2022 to January 2023*
Java fundamentals, REST APIs, version control, Jira. Built BlackoutAPI: a load-shedding tool that syncs Eskom schedules to Google Calendar.

N6 in Mechanical Engineering | College of Cape Town | *2015 to 2017*

VOLUNTEERING

Director of Technical Operations and Youth Development
The Open Mosque, Wynberg, Cape Town | November 2023 to present

- Manage the full ICT portfolio for the mosque: CCTV, network infrastructure, domain and DNS management, website, and a basic security operations function. Everything is set up with automated monitoring and failover so problems surface and get handled without needing manual intervention.
- Run the Open Youth Programme alongside this role. Free daily coding classes, homework support, and mentorship for young people aged 6 to 25. The HotDeskZA initiative (started January 2025) provides a daily workspace, Wi-Fi, and a free meal.

REFERENCES

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